

Joseph Kasongo

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Summary

Computer Science and Business Computing graduate from the University of Cape Town, currently completing a BCom Honours in Information Systems. Hands-on experience building full-stack web applications, data visualisation tools, fintech prototypes, and AI-assisted product features. Skilled in JavaScript, Python, Vue.js, Next.js, FastAPI, Firebase, and database-driven system design, with experience taking projects from problem discovery to working prototypes and stakeholder presentations. Seeking an entry-level software developer role where I can contribute to real-world systems, strengthen my engineering discipline, and grow into a well-rounded developer.

Education History

University of Cape Town:	Bachelor of Commerce Honours in Information Systems (Currently enrolled)
	Bachelor of Science in Computer Science and Business Computing (Graduated 2025)
University of the Western Cape:	Bachelor of Science in Computer Science (First Year - 2021) Dean's Merit Awards (Best First Year Student)
Relevant Coursework:	System Analysis, Design & Development, Data Structure & Algorithms, Databases, Machine Learning, Parallel Computing, Mobile Design, Computer Networks, Project Management, ERP & Business Process Management.

Work Experience

February 2024 – Present: Tutor, University of Cape Town

- Tutor for INF2011S: Systems Analysis, Design and Development, supporting students with systems design concepts, assignments, project work, and practical application.
- Previously tutored CSC2001F: Databases and Data Structures and CSC2002S: Parallel Computing, Computer Architecture, and Mobile Design and Development during 2024.
- Assisted students with technical concepts, assignment requirements, and development-related problem-solving.
- Supported lecturers with marking tests, assignments, and practical submissions.
- Developed strong communication, mentoring, technical explanation, and academic support skills.

July 2024: Vacation Student, Byte Orbit

- Designed and developed an interactive web application for agile teams to estimate story points during sprint planning (Scrum Poker).
- Built a responsive user interface using Vue.js, Vuetify, and CSS to support a smooth user experience across devices.
- Collaborated with a team to deliver the project within a short vacation-work period.
- Presented the final product to Byte Orbit stakeholders, explaining the technical implementation, user flow, and project functionality.

July 2022 – January 2023: Technical Support Agent, Payment24

- Provided customer and technical support by phone, email, and in person.
- Diagnosed software and hardware-related issues and guided users through troubleshooting steps.
- Supported communication during new project deployments in French-speaking countries.

Skills acquired: Time management, Collaboration, Teamwork, Communication, Problem-Solving, Adaptability, Attention to detail.

Projects

UniSwap – Student Resale Storefront

Next.js, Tailwind CSS, Firebase Auth, Firestore, Firebase Storage, Vercel

- Built a university resale web app for browsing, searching, and purchasing items.
- Implemented customer, guest, and admin flows including cart, checkout simulation, product and order management.
- Used Firebase Authentication and Firestore for role-based access control.
- Designed data models for users, products, categories, carts, wishlists, and orders with UCT-domain restrictions.
- Added AI-assisted features such as product summaries and prompt-based search.

MaliGo – Behaviour-First Savings App

React Native, Expo, Supabase, Financial Technology, Product Strategy, UX Research

- Designed a behaviour-first savings app concept focused on helping young users build better financial habits.
- Worked on product discovery, including competitor analysis, lean canvas development, user personas, customer journeys, and MVP feature definition.
- Defined MVP features such as login, savings tracking, and analytics dashboard.
- Focused on behaviour change, accessibility, and financial inclusion.

Research Visualisation - ResViz (Capstone Project)

Python (FastAPI), Vue.js, D3.js, Cytoscape.js, SQLite

- Developed a web application to visualise research collaborations within a university environment.
- Built interactive network visualisations allowing users to filter by research topics, departments, and collaboration strength.
- Contributed to both backend API development and frontend visualisation logic.

Peer-to-Peer Lending Platform – Lown (Hackathon Project)

Next.js, Tailwind CSS, Node.js, Open Payments API

- Conceptualized and developed a financial inclusion platform enabling micro-lending and transparent digital contracts.
- Built lender and borrower dashboard flows with wallet connection functionality and loan agreement concepts.
- Participated in the FinHub x Interledger Hackathon, applying open payment standards to a practical financial technology use case.

Technical Skills

Languages: Java, Python, C++, C#, JavaScript, HTML, CSS

Frameworks & Libraries: Vue.js, React, React Native, .NET, FastAPI, Node.js, Tailwind CSS, D3.js

Tools & Platforms: Firebase, Supabase, Vercel, Expo, Figma, SAP S/4HANA, Git, Shopify, Wix.

Concepts: OOP, System Design, Data Visualisation, Machine Learning, Agile Development.